

Jay Prakash Sharma, PhD

Sociocultural anthropologist studying extraction, bureaucracy, citizenship, Indigenous politics, development, and democracy in South Asia.

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Postdoctoral Research Fellow

Center for the Advanced Study of India (CASI), University of Pennsylvania | 2026-2028

Developing a book manuscript based on doctoral research; organizing the weekly seminar series; and mentoring graduate students affiliated with Anthropology and South Asia Studies.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Anthropology • Indigenous Studies • Extraction and Its Afterlives • Bureaucracy and Citizenship • Democracy and Political Subjectivity • Development • South Asia

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Cultural Anthropology, with Distinction

Syracuse University | August 2025

Dissertation: Negotiating Development: Adivasi Resistance, State Developmentalism, and the Making of Lesser Citizens in Jharkhand, India

Committee: Susan S. Wadley (Advisor), Azra Hromadžić, Mona Bhan, Ann G. Gold, and Uday Chandra

M.A. in Cultural Anthropology

Syracuse University | June 2019

M.Phil. in Sociology

University of Delhi | June 2015

Dissertation: Development and Discontent: Relevance of Polanyi's Double Movement in Chhattisgarh, India

M.A. in Development Studies

Tata Institute of Social Sciences | May 2011

Dissertation: Policy Innovation in MGNREGA: A Case Study of Banking Correspondent

B.A. in Russian Language, Literature and Cultural Studies

Jawaharlal Nehru University | 2009

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Under review. "The Sedimentation of Indifference: Bureaucracy, Social Difference, and Adivasi Citizenship in Eastern India." *Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute*.
- Under review. "Unsettling Indigeneity: The Struggle to Remake Adivasi Identity in a Hindu India." Co-authored with Uday Chandra. Special issue of *Asian Ethnicity*.
- 2023. "Frontiers of Capital: Exploring the Notion of Labor among Hos of West Singhbhum, Jharkhand." *Journal of Tribal Intellectual Collective India* 7, Special Issue 4: 72-92.
- 2017. "Primitive Accumulations at the Margins: Commodification of Land and Labour in Chhattisgarh." Co-authored with Kamei Aphun. *Economic and Political Weekly* 52(28).

Book Chapter

- 2022. "Experiences of and Responses to COVID-19 in a Ho Tribal Village in Jharkhand." In S. Acharya and Stephen Christopher, eds., *Caste, COVID-19, and Inequalities of Care: Lessons from South Asia*, 151-169. DOI: 10.1007/978-981-16-6917-0.

Public Scholarship

- 2025. "Good Bureaucrats and God: An Interview with Maira Hayat." *Supplementals, Fieldsights*, May 6.

Manuscript in Progress

- “Claiming Citizenship: Vernaculars of Democracy and Adivasi Youth Mobilizations in Eastern India.” Planned submission to Cultural Anthropology.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- 2026. Doctoral Prize, Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University.
- 2024. Graduate Student Travel Grant, Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University.
- 2024. Claudia De Lys Graduate Scholar in Cultural Anthropology, Syracuse University.
- 2020-2022. American Institute of Indian Studies Junior Fellowship, funded by the National Endowment for the Humanities.
- 2021. Claudia De Lys Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Syracuse University.
- 2021. John S. Burdick Memorial Scholarship, Syracuse University.
- 2019. Graduate Student Travel Grant, Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University.
- 2018. Bharati Memorial Grant for Summer Research, South Asia Center, Syracuse University.
- 2017-2018. Dean's Summer Fellowship, Maxwell School, Syracuse University.
- 2014. Indian Council of Social Science Research International Travel Grant.
- 2013-2015. University Grants Commission NET Fellowship, India.
- 2009-2011. Tuition Fee Waiver Grant for Meritorious Students, Tata Institute of Social Sciences.
- 2006-2009. Merit-cum-Means Scholarship, Jawaharlal Nehru University.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Institution	Course and Role	Year
Bucknell University	Instructor, Introduction to Cultural Anthropology	Spring 2026
Syracuse University	Teaching Assistant, Global Encounters: Comparing World Views and Values Cross-Culturally	2023-2025
Syracuse University	Teaching Assistant, Peoples and Cultures of the World	2018-2019; 2022-2023
Syracuse University	Teaching Instructor, Critical Issues for the United States	2021-2022
Syracuse University	Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Biological Anthropology	Spring 2017
Syracuse University	Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Cultural Anthropology	Fall 2016

INVITED TALKS AND LECTURES

- 2025. “Indigeneity in India,” South Asia Speakers Series, Georgetown University, Washington, DC.
- 2025. “Mining Inequality: An Ethnographic Study,” Department of Anthropology, Syracuse University.
- 2024. “State, Development and the Indigenous People of South Asia,” Cornell-Syracuse South Asia Consortium, Onondaga Community College.
- 2023. “Mine, Money and the Community: Revisiting ‘Tribal Economy’ through Life Histories of Ho Adivasis in Jharkhand, India,” South Asia Center, Syracuse University.
- 2022. “Tribes and the Indian State: The Ho of Jharkhand and Gaddis of Himachal Pradesh,” South Asia Center, Syracuse University.
- 2020. “Idea of Development from a Sociological Point of View,” Miranda College, University of Delhi.

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

- 2026. Panel co-organizer, “Extraction: Political and Ecological Afterlives,” American Anthropological Association Annual Meeting.
- 2024. Panel organizer, “Democracy, Development and the Subaltern,” Annual Conference on South Asia, University of Wisconsin-Madison.
- 2024. “Claiming Modernity from Below: Cultural Politics of Development and Tribal Youth Aspiration in Jharkhand, India,” Annual Conference on South Asia.
- 2024. Discussant, roundtable on Resistance as Negotiation: Making States and Tribes in the Margins of Modern India, Annual Conference on South Asia.
- 2022. “Between Hopelessness and Aspirations: COVID-19 and Narratives of Migrant Laborers from Nakhasa, Jharkhand,” Oslo Metropolitan University-JKL Workshop.

- 2019. "Formation of Subaltern Political Consciousness: Adivasi Political Activism against Land Acquisition in Chhattisgarh, India," Medusa Graduate Conference, University of Toronto.
- 2019. "Stories We Are Told, Stories We Tell: Explorations in Ethnographic Methods," Graduate Students' Workshop, Syracuse University.
- 2018. "Adivasi Political Consciousness: Looking beyond Indigenous Religion," Annual Conference on South Asia.
- 2016. "State and Expansion of Market Ideology: Locating Polanyi's Double Movement in India," Centre for Development Studies, Thiruvananthapuram.
- 2014. "Analyzing Primitive Accumulation at the Margins," Historical Materialism Conference, London.
- 2011. "Impact of Smart Cards on MGNREGA Wage Disbursement in Warangal, Andhra Pradesh," Indian Society of Labour Economics Annual Conference.

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Consultant

September-December 2025

Examined the historical experiences of the Paswan caste across northern India and their impact on the modern painting traditions of Paswan Mithila artists.

Contributing Editor

Society for Cultural Anthropology, Teaching Tools | 2024-2026

Project Associate

Ambedkar University Delhi and Norwegian Institute of International Affairs | 2015-2016

Analyzed corporate governance, taxation, and corporate social responsibility frameworks in India and contributed to comparative research on governance regimes and corporate accountability.

Research Officer

Tata Institute of Social Sciences, Mumbai | 2013

Evaluated World Bank-funded livelihood schemes in Chhattisgarh, with attention to women's income and financial autonomy among tribal communities.

Research Associate

Institute for Human Development, New Delhi | 2011-2013

Evaluated development policies and scholarship schemes for marginalized communities and researched the livelihoods and vulnerabilities of women home-based workers.

LANGUAGES

- Hindi: Proficient in speaking, reading, and writing.
- Russian: Introductory speaking, reading, and writing.

Last updated July 2026.